Summary Report for Azure Region Selection & Shared Responsibility Model

1. Introduction

This report provides a brief overview of the selected Azure region for deployed resources and explains how the Microsoft Azure Shared Responsibility Model applies to the deployed cloud resource.

2. Selected Azure Region

The chosen region for deploying resources is:

South Africa North

Reason for Selection:

- It is the closest Azure region to Nigeria, ensuring lower network latency.
- It provides better performance for applications accessed from West Africa.
- It supports most core Azure services required for development and testing.
- It helps maintain compliance with data residency and regional data handling preferences.

Where South Africa North was not available for specific services, **West Europe** was considered as a fallback option due to its stability and availability of services.

3. Deployed Resource

The primary deployed resource considered in this setup is a:

Virtual Machine (VM) / Storage Account (Azure Free Tier Resource)

This resource is hosted within a selected resource group under the Azure subscription and is managed through Azure Cost Management and Governance tools.

4. Shared Responsibility Model (Explanation)

The Microsoft Azure Shared Responsibility Model defines how security and management responsibilities are divided between Microsoft (the cloud provider) and the customer (the user, in this instance – Victor Mgboh).

Microsoft's Responsibility (Cloud Provider)

Microsoft is responsible for:

- Physical security of data centers
- Hardware infrastructure (servers, storage, networking)

- Virtualization layer and hypervisor security
- Ensuring availability and redundancy of cloud services
- Maintaining Azure platform updates and patching of underlying systems

Customer Responsibility (User / Victor Mgboh)

As the Azure user, the responsibilities include:

- Configuring and managing virtual machines or storage accounts
- Securing access using identity and access management (IAM / Entra ID)
- Applying security patches inside the operating system (for VMs)
- Managing network security rules (firewalls, NSGs)
- Monitoring usage and cost through Azure Cost Management
- Ensuring proper deletion of unused resources to avoid charges

5. Application to Deployed Resource

For the deployed Virtual Machine or Storage Account:

- Microsoft ensures the **physical server and Azure infrastructure remain secure and operational**.
- Victor Mgboh is responsible for:
  - Configuring access credentials (passwords/SSH keys)
  - Installing and updating software inside the VM
  - Controlling who can access the resource
  - Monitoring usage and cost consumption

This division ensures that while Microsoft secures the cloud platform, Victor Mgboh maintains control and responsibility over the data and applications they deploy.

6. Conclusion

The selected Azure region (South Africa North) provides optimal performance for West African usage scenarios. The Shared Responsibility Model ensures a balanced approach where Microsoft secures the infrastructure while Victor Mgboh manages configuration, security, and operational usage of deployed resources.